

Funding Circle SEO Proposal

April 2026

The opportunity

Funding Circle has ten years of domain authority, proprietary lending data, and a product suite that applies to almost every financial moment a UK SME will face. Currently, SEO sits between three teams, with agency support. What it needs to scale is strategic ownership over how that authority is deployed across organic search. Content is produced article-by-article against a narrow topic set, with no unified topic architecture, a flat chronological archive, and a compliance process that slows everything down.

What I propose

Two days a week, for six months, as the fractional strategic lead on SEO content. I own the plan, the architecture, the publishing process, and the writer operation, solved in that order, because each phase unlocks the next.

The four elements

- **Content plan and keyword alignment.** Map the full universe of topics UK SMEs search for across their commercial and financial life. Prioritise by commercial relevance, competitive vulnerability and ability to win. This becomes the brief for everything else.
- **Site architecture.** Restructure to match the plan. Three options in scope: hub-and-spoke within the existing resource centre; dedicated topic verticals on the main domain; or priority-vertical subdomains for territories Funding Circle commits to dominating. Subdomains are harder to set up but easier to start with than retrofit, and give search engines the clearest possible topical signal at scale.
- **Compliance.** Redesign the workflow around content categories. Risk-tiered review paths, pre-flagged danger zones, brief templates that front-load compliance, and a pre-approved vocabulary bank for recurring topics. Built in collaboration with the compliance team, to support them rather than make more work.
- **Production.** I write the first pilots to set tone. Then vetted writers I've worked with before, briefed and reviewed by me before anything touches compliance. Blue Array's scope gets redefined toward deeper keyword and competitor research, which I turn into brand-aligned briefs. Focus is depth and authority over volume, consistency at a pace compliance can absorb, scaling as constraints lift.

Phased plan

- **Months 1-2:** Content audit, topic universe map, competitive landscape, keyword strategy, architectural recommendation, 2-3 pilot articles written by me.
- **Months 2-3:** Compliance workflow redesign, brief templates, vocabulary bank, 4-6 further pilots tested through the new workflow, Blue Array scope recommendation.
- **Months 3-6:** Writer pod onboarded, first priority topic territory built out, stable publishing cadence, monthly reporting on territory capture and commercial metrics.

Commercial

Two days per week at £500/day, billed monthly at ~£4,300. Six months of my time: ~£25,800. Writer costs scoped separately in Phase 3 at £300-£330 per article. Review points at Month 3 (natural exit if not working) and Month 6 (decision point for continuing). Rolling monthly through High Beam Digital Ltd, one month notice.